DR Care Solutions

Danielle Robertson Consulting Pty Ltd trading as DR Care Solutions

ABN 44 605 748 392 ACN 605 748 392
3408/1 Sergeants Lane, St Leonards NSW 2065

Overview for Residential Aged Care Placement

CLIENTS NAME: **CAROLINE 'NAGASURI' RALSTON**
DOB: **17.12.1944 (80 years of age)**
CLIENT ID: **DRCS 0544**

This overview is a summary completed for all clients requiring Placement into Residential Respite or Residential permanent aged care, assisted living or group home. The overview is undertaken by a consultant from DR Care Solutions. It's used as a guideline outlining the background and needs of a specific client(s).

Issues covered: • Emotional & mental health • Physical health including mobility, continence, • Cognitive health • Sensory (sight, hearing, oral, feet) requirements • Activities of daily living • Medications, allergies & vaccinations • External assistance - including Allied Health • Social background, networks and Relationships • Likes & dislikes	**Background and relevant history;** Cheryl 'Kamalamayi' Hyde reached out to Danielle from DR Care Solutions on Monday 10th March 2025 to discuss her concerns about her close friend, Caroline (also known as 'Nagasuri') and her current ageing care and living needs. Nagasuri has developed increased anxiety, depression and has been working through some significant mental health issues over the last 12 to 24 months. We had further discussions over the phone with Nagasuri's son, Torben Ralston on Thursday 13th March 2025. We agreed on moving ahead to find Nagasuri's next home in a supported living environment. Torben and Danielle caught up over Zoom on Friday 28th March 2025 to capture information for this summary. Nagasuri was too unwell to join us on the call that day. Cheryl (Kamalamayi) was referred to Danielle through the Buddhist Community. Danielle has recently assisted a friend of theirs from the community into a supported living environment. We have received a copy of Nagasuri's GP Health Plan. It states a medical history of Hepatitis A (in 1959), Discectomy (1989), Cataracts (2014 & 2015), anxiety disorder (2017), Osteopenia (2019), right shoulder injury (2023), panic attacks and melancholic depression (2023/ 2024), postural hypotension with frequent falls (2025) *inter alia*. **Emotional & mental health:** Nagasuri suffers from anxiety, depression and panic attacks. She has had many hospitalisations over the last two years where Nagasuri commenced having ECT (Electroconvulsive therapies). After sixteen treatments, there was a vast improvement in her mental health. Torben was thrilled to see his mother so upbeat.

● Cultural linguistic and Spiritual needs ● Estate Plan/ Advice and Life Ready Register ● Funeral arrangements ● Financial Plan/ Advice ● My Aged Care ● Criteria for next home	Unfortunately, Nagasuri purchased a new Iphone (after previously using an Android phone), and she developed problems with her email not working. This distressed her. Additionally, a significant cladding issue arose with her apartment block causing her to regress mentally. Significant levies were required to have the cladding rectified, she had to move items away from her windows and this added to her anxiety and depression. These issues have exacerbated and contributed to her stress and poor mental health again. She's had over 12 ECT's since December 2024 since this regression and is now doing three weekly 'maintenance' ECT treatments through the Northside Clinic (Ramsay Health at St Leonards) without noticeable improvement. This week's treatment was cancelled due to her ACAT assessment taking place at the same time. Torben is quite concerned that the treatments are no longer assisting her. She continues treatment under the guidance of a psychiatrist. Ideally, Torben would love for his mother's mental health to improve and for her to be more positive and return to her previous level of vitality where she was about five years ago. **Physical health including mobility, continence:** Nagasuri has had several falls likely due to low blood pressure. These have mainly occurred while she's been an inpatient at the Northside clinic and after her treatments. She mobilises independently **without** a walking stick or a four wheeled wheelie walker. She's had a few episodes of bowel and bladder leakages (rather than incontinences) generally after an ECT treatment due to the sedating effect. Her physical health has declined because of these treatments. She is easily exhausted physically whereas she was previously quite fit and enjoyed swimming. **Cognitive health:** Nagasuri has had more than thirty general anaesthetics in the last six months and each time her cognition declines for a period afterwards. Given her high intelligence this is worrying her. **Sensory:** Nagasuri wears glasses for reading. She's had Lasix surgery. She doesn't wear hearing aids, nor does she need them as her hearing is intact. She has all her own teeth (no dentures) and doesn't visit a podiatrist. **Activities of daily living:** Nagasuri is managing her personal care and hygiene tasks and dressing independently. She is finding dressing and washing her hair increasingly difficult due to her rotator cuff (shoulder) injury. She's still cooking however struggles with it and the preparation and clean up is difficult and daunting for her. She is no longer driving after surrendering her license due to the low blood pressure. Nagasuri is 50 kg. She is a vegetarian; she doesn't drink nor smoke.

	Nagasuri requires assistance with meals, transport, shopping, cleaning and companionship. She's currently socially isolated, however has a large community on a WhatsApp group around her who care about her. She is not actually a member of this WhatsApp group however, Torben is. Nagasuri wakes around 4-5am each day. She stays in bed until 7am. She makes her breakfast and depending on her energy levels determines what she does for the day. She walks to the local mini-mart and chemist, she reads and watches TV Shows and documentaries that a friend has given her on an external hard drive. She listens to the Radio (ABC / Radio National) and enjoys listening to classical music. She avoids listening to news and current affairs. **Medications, vaccinations & allergies:** Nagasuri is allergic to Mirtazapine (it has a sedating effect). She is fully vaccinated for Covid, Flu and Shingles. We will need to ensure we have an update of her medications as she's spent some time in Northside Clinic where they have been attempting to improve the levels of her low blood pressure medications and her anxiety / depression medications. Torben mentioned that his mother has gone through at least seven different medications for anxiety and depression trying to find the right medications working well together for her. Her current medications include: • Fosamax (to treat osteoporosis) • Olanzapine (an atypical antipsychotic for those with bi-polar disorder) • Parnate (an antidepressant) which Nagasuri advised has been discontinued and she's experiencing difficulties as a result. **Social background, networks, and relationships:** Nagasuri was born in Palmerston North in New Zealand. She relocated to Adelaide when she was 12 years of age. She has an older sister who lives in Tasmania. Her sister recently lost her husband. She had a younger brother who passed away 10 years ago in Nimbin. Her mother developed dementia, and this provides Nagasuri with more anxiety as she fears development of dementia. Nagasuri attended primary and secondary School in Adelaide. Initially, she did a Bachelor of Arts (Honours) at the University of Adelaide before heading off to ANU in Canberra and undertook a degree in Pacific History and a PHD.

	Nagasuri obtained a job at Macquarie University as a lecturer and became head of the History, Philosophy and Politics School at Macquarie University. Her whole life was career driven and she focussed on her work. She met and married Torben's dad in the 1960s. In 1977, when Torben was 11, they separated and divorced. Torben's father left Nagasuri to pursue a different relationship. Torben lived with both parents after the separation and moved in with his father around 1995 when Nagasuri moved to Coogee. In 1995, Nagasuri relocated to Coogee to a women's commune. The Buddhist practise and the Buddhist Centre (in Newtown) has been the life blood that Nagasuri needed since that time. After 1995, she lived in Buddhist Communities and found a sense of meaning. She had some mild anxiety at that time as she was arranging retreats and lessons for others. She was spending a lot of time alone which didn't help her stress levels. There has been a steady decline in her mental health over the years. Nagasuri assisted with the Ankali Project (in Sydney) which provided her with training and support needed to help people living with HIV/ AIDS. Nagasuri spent up to 6 months each year living in India and the UK, learning and spreading the Dharma practise. Torben's father passed away when Torben was about 20 years of age. His father was 53 years old. Torben advised that Nagasuri has become quite insulated into the Buddhist Community. She has a wonderful network of supportive Buddhist friends from the Buddhist Community who are in touch with her from time to time. Given Torben lives on the Central Coast, he spends as much time as he can with her. She has previously spent time with him and his family and at their regular holiday location of Seal Rocks. He is currently up there until just before Easter when he will return to the Entrance. Torben runs his own Pest Control Company, and he is based at The Entrance on the Central Coast of NSW. Torben has a 7-year-old daughter, Winnie. Winnie's mother, Roxy (real name Jemina) and Torben live together. They are regularly in touch with Nagasuri and previously visited them monthly. Ideally, she'd love to get back to doing that on her own without having to rely on Torben to collect her. **Likes & dislikes:** Nagasuri used to be a very strong swimmer. She's unable to swim now due to her rotator cuff injury however would probably like to walk up and down in a pool. (Incontinence or leakage issues would need to be under control if she were able to access a pool).

	Nagasuri likes Pilates (using the reformer) which has helped her shoulder issues. She does lack occupation and is often bored. Nagasuri likes thoughtful conversation. She enjoys doing the "Quiz" in the Herald when she's with Torben. She generally doesn't read newspapers, watch the news or current affair programs on television due to the negativity of what's happening in the world. Nagasuri reads good fiction and enjoys 'physical books' rather than online or using a Kindle. While Nagasuri is underweight currently, we know she enjoys almond croissants and pastries, cookies, fresh fruit and vegetables. She doesn't have exotic tastes and enjoys baked potatoes, capsicums and eggs. She drinks water and is aware she needs water to aid hydration. When living in India, she was Vegan however is Vegetarian now. Nagasuri used to love sewing and still enjoys going to the Art Gallery of NSW and listening to classical and other music (her nieces and nephews are professional violinists). She prefers daytime activities and outings rather than night. She loves reading literature and continuing to learn. Nagasuri loves visiting the seaside and enjoys watching 'Nipper' carnivals. She has a friend at Seal Rocks and visits him when she's there. We understand that she has only managed one visit in the last 9 months to see Torben due to her ongoing treatments. She was visiting monthly up until then. She was able to use Public Transport however, moving forward Torben will come and collect her once she's settled into her new home however her wish is to try using public transport on her own again. **Cultural, linguistic & Spiritual needs:** Nagasuri speaks only English. She's quite spiritual as a practising Buddhist. Torben is unsure if Nagasuri continues to meditate however she's very mindful of the Buddhist principles. Nagasuri has advised Torben that she would be fine in any 'faith-based home' if she's not forced to attend services. **Estate Plan/ Advice:** Our understanding is that Nagasuri has Powers of Attorney (for financial decisions should she lose capacity) and Enduring Guardianship (for health, care and accommodation decisions should she lose capacity) documents in place. Torben, being Nagasuri's only child is listed as both. We have not sighted these documents. They will need to be produced to the chosen home. **Advanced Care Directive:** Below we include a special DR Care Solutions link to Touchstone Life Care for building an Advanced Care Directive. You are welcome to use this or ask your GP for a paper-based document if it's preferred.

This is usually stored in the client's GP Health Summary and hospital records should something occur, the medical profession adheres to the requests if the person is unable to communicate their wants, needs and wishes. Touchstone Life Care - A DR Care Solutions Partner

Funeral arrangements: Nagasuri and Danielle chatted about this. It wasn't discussed with Torben. She articulated that she would like to have a funeral run by White Lady organisation, with a celebration of life at the Buddhist Centre in Newtown after the funeral.

Life Ready Register: For DR Care Solutions clients, we provide a copy of the Life Ready Register, a depository to keep all your affairs in one place. We suggest that you download this and start completing it. No matter what age, everyone can commence building this out and sharing it with their trusted network, their Powers of Attorney and Enduring Guardians as well as their Executor of their Will. Life Ready Register™

Financial Plan / Advice: Nagasuri owns her apartment in Camperdown outright. She has never obtained financial advice and Torben believes that she may have an accountant. We will need an estimated budget for a refundable accommodation deposit for her to enter care. We don't have insight into her assets nor financial situation. She will be a RAD payer.

Should Nagasuri and Torben need to have a discussion with an Aged Care Accredited Financial Adviser, we can make an introduction to an adviser to initially have a chat. They provide strategies on the best way of funding Nagasuri's aged care.

My Aged Care: Two of Nagasuri's friends, Kamalamayi (Cheryl) and Padmadakini have registered her with My Aged Care. Her Aged Care number is AC 8344 6658. We are waiting to hear when her ACAT assessment will occur given the urgency of needing Nagasuri to relocate into a supported living environment.

Torben and Danielle agreed that we will commence the search for a suitable home for Nagasuri even if the ACAT Assessment hasn't yet been completed. Torben advised Danielle that the ACAT assessment is occurring on **Thursday 3rd April 2025**. We will add the codes to this summary once we receive them.

We URGENTLY need the **following referral codes** for Nagasuri to enter residential care: **a) residential respite care and b) residential permanent care.** These referral codes unlock the funding to enable people over the age of 65 years to enter a supported living environment.

	We received the Referral codes from the ACAT Assessor on: 6th April 2025 **REFERRAL CODES:** **For residential respite: 2-159 019 381 402** **For residential permanent care: 2- 159 019 381 467** **Criteria for next home:** Torben suggests Newtown be the centre of where the search for Nagasuri's next home is and work out from there (west of Newtown). A home that has peaceful gardens and walking paths would be ideal. A home that is close to public transport to enable her to visit the Buddhist Centre in Newtown and access to the arts and culture (galleries) in the city would be fabulous. She will be RAD (Refundable Accommodation Deposit) payer. A single room and ensuite are required for her. Other likeminded individuals as part of the resident mix would be ideal. A home that can cater to her vegetarian diet and manage her medications is needed and to support her through her ageing care journey.
Actions required (for the client to achieve these goals)	Danielle from DR Care Solutions is to locate a minimum of FOUR Aged Care homes in the Inner West of Sydney who can manage Nagasuri's care needs now and into the future. The selected home will need to be able to manage all her care requirements (outlined herein), have the availability for respite with a view to permanent care and be able to provide top quality care, support services with appropriate social interaction and activities for her to participate in. Her care needs currently, are quite low however likely to increase as she ages and her mental health condition progresses. Once these have been located, pre-vetting, due diligence, clinical acceptance, and tours will begin. We have diarised **Monday 28th April 2025** as a possible date for tours of local homes in the inner west of Sydney. Torben is on annual leave in Seal Rocks until Easter. Once Nagasuri's ACAT assessment is completed and tours have been arranged, we will look to relocate her as quickly as possible, depending on availability of the selected home, the ACAT codes coming through and clinical acceptance of Nagasuri into a home.

Who will be involved: (Guardian, solicitor, financial planner / advisers, family members)	● Torben Ralston and Caroline 'Nagasuri' Ralston ● Danielle Robertson from DR Care Solutions ● GP, Psychiatrist and anyone else involved in Nagasuri's medical care and treatment ● Estate Lawyer (review of all estate planning documents) ● Financial adviser (Aged Care Accredited) if required.
Review of Summary for Placements and the date the Family need to determine next steps:	Friday 4th April 2025

Signature (Consultant):  Date: Wednesday 2nd April 2025

UPDATED: 7th April 2025

This document is issued by Danielle Robertson Consulting Pty Limited ABN 44 605 748 392 trading as DR Care Solutions. This document contains proprietary information of DR Care Solutions and is intended for the exclusive use of the parties to whom it is provided by DR Care Solutions. Its content may not be modified, sold or otherwise provided, in whole or in part, to any other person or entity without DR Care Solutions prior written permission. © 2025 Danielle Robertson Consulting Pty Limited. All Rights Reserved